

TROPHIES OF GRACE

2 Timothy 2:20-22 (NJKV) ***“But in a great house there are not only vessels of gold and silver, but also of wood and clay, some for honor and some for dishonor. 21 Therefore if anyone cleanses himself from the latter, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified and useful for the Master, prepared for every good work. 22 Flee also youthful lusts; but pursue righteousness, faith, love, peace with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart.”***

INTRO: Today we have paused to recognize and celebrate the goodness of God with testimonies from our:

- Life Groups...
- Freedom Weekends...
- Project Hope...
- Saving Grace...
- Water Baptisms...

The “***Great House***” in our text is the church – the household of faith, the family of God.

Even in God’s house there are those vessels that are fit for noble purposes and those that are not.

In our modern homes there are vessels for different purposes.

Vessels of honor:

- China dishes...
- Family heirlooms...
- Antiques and keepsakes...

Vessels of dishonor:

- Cleaning rags...
- Trash cans...
- Floor mats...

In the great house there were vessels of honor and dishonor. All of us can be vessels of honor also known as “***Trophies of Grace.***” The difference between vessels of dishonor and “***Trophies of grace***” is very simple – “***If***

anyone cleanses himself, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified and useful for the Master, prepared for every good work.”

Each person we celebrate today was once a vessel of dishonor but today they are being celebrated as a ***“Trophy of Grace.”*** How is this possible? It is possible by doing three things:

- Cleanse yourself... (Nothing but the blood – I’m not perfect, just forgiven)
- Flee youthful lusts... (Most addictions and self-defeating life patterns begin in our youth)
- Pursue righteousness... (The proof of desire is pursuit)

If you do these three things you will miraculously be transformed from a vessel of dishonor into a ***“Trophy of Grace!”***